

Symbian^3

Symbian^3, is the Latest Symbian platform release. The Symbian Platform is the successor of Symbian OS, while the latter required an additional user interface system, Symbian Platform integrated a user interface component based on the S60V5 into the platform itself. It is currently available on flagship devices such as the Nokia N8 and Nokia C7-00. We will now elaborate on a few tips and tricks to enhance your experience. Many of these tips will work on a S60V5 device also.

USB on-the-go

One of the most talked about and loved feature of Symbian^3 is the ability to natively support USB on-the-go, what it means is that it provides powered access to USB peripherals. For example, you can directly connect a pen-drive to your phone (via a cable) and read/transfer data without the need to tether your phone to a computer. Now more interestingly, you can actually connect a USB mouse to your phone: Yes your standard desktop mouse. Once connected, the mouse pointer will be visible on the phone's screen. Left-click of the mouse will be equivalent to a tap. Similarly, a right-click will minimise the application or open the menu. But the



One big step towards substituting your netbook with your phone

best part is that you can scroll through the gallery or list by using the scroll wheel of your mouse at amazing speeds.

Scheduled profiles

Did you know your phone can even schedule the changeover of profiles for you. For example, you can set the profile to silent for your bed timings and make it automatically shift to general at your wake up time. To do this, open Profiles in the Settings menu. Select the profile you want to schedule and then choose Timed. It will then give you the option of entering the preferred time for each profile. Remember that once the time for any profile expires, it will switch back to the last active profile.

Power saving

Symbian^3 added a Power Saving Profile for some devices. When switched to, the phone will Dim the display, disable Bluetooth, disable screensavers and switch to GSM-only from 3G. It is a great way to extend your battery life when you are running close to 15-20 per cent and want to survive for a few extra hours. Like others, you can access it merely by pressing the power button and then selecting it from available profiles.

Video

The video taking application provided by Symbian^3 supports "Video Stabilisation". A simple and effective way of reducing motion jerks. To use it, open the camera application and switch to video mode. Go to Options > Settings and turn the "Video Stabilization" to ON. It is often complained that the Audio quality of the built-in voice recorder is not satisfactory. So if you are someone who use the Audio recording application often for taking

notes, interview or in general then you should go to Options > Settings after opening the recorder app and find the field

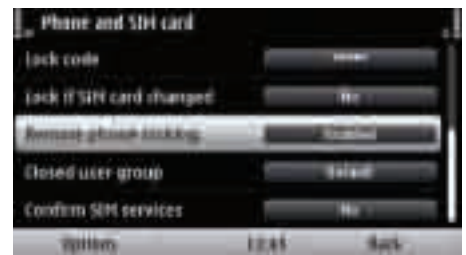
Recording Quality and change that to High.

Right-clicks

A lot of touchscreen interface users might not be aware that pressing and holding any menu listing would simulate a right click, and would typically present you with context options. For example if you are in the Call Log, and you press and hold any number or contact, it will give you an option to send an SMS straight away. Similarly under contacts, you can press and hold any contact from the list to get an option to send it as a 'Business Card' via SMS.

Quick Bluetooth switching

Symbian has often been criticised for not having a dedicated shortcut or easy access menu listing for Bluetooth power on and off, especially before the introduction of widgetised home screen. But did you know you can toggle Bluetooth power by simply pressing and holding the * key.



Safeguarding your data, remotely

Finding your MAC address

Every network interface of each device has its own unique MAC address. If your Wi-Fi network, at home or office, needs authentication via MAC, here is a simple way to find your phone's wireless MAC address. Simply type *#62209526#. If you entered the code correctly, you wouldn't need to press the dial button to get the notification message with your WLAN MAC address.

Multiple home screens

Symbian^3, like Android and other interfaces supports multiple homescreens.

Upto three on most devices. If you think that is a little too much information overload then you can reduce them very simply by clicking options after switching to the home screen you want to delete and then choosing 'delete' from the context menu. If you later decide to change your mind and want to add a homescreen then go the homescreen after [on the right side] which you want the new homescreen. Click Options and then choose "New Home Screen". Symbian^3 provides added security to your portable device by giving an option to lock it remotely in case of theft or similar unwanted circumstances. You will of course need to enable this before you loose the possession of your phone. This can be accomplished by Going to Settings > Phone

> Phone Management then you will have to navigate to Security Settings > Phone and SIM Card. Under this there will be a field named Remote phone locking. Enable it. Enter a remote locking message or a password. Tapping on the time display will quickly take you the "New Alarm" screen. Right next to it you can try tapping in the blank area next to the clock and it will give you a profile selection menu and open calendar option. While clicking near the battery, it will give you the option to access the connectivity and clock settings. Very discreet and a huge time saver. 